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Date: 7 Oct 2026

Task 7

Phishing Email Analysis

Phishing Indicator Checklist

Sr no.	<u>Indicator</u>	<u>What to Check</u>
1.	Sender Address	Check whether the sender's email address is genuine or suspicious.
2.	Display Name	Verify that the displayed sender name matches the actual email address.
3.	Suspicious Links	Check whether links lead to an unexpected or fake website.
4.	Urgent Language	Look for messages creating panic or urgency, such as “Act Now” or “Account Will Be Blocked.”
5.	Attachments	Be careful with unexpected or suspicious attachments.
6.	Spelling & Grammar	Check for unusual spelling, grammar, or formatting mistakes.

7.	Request for Information	Be suspicious of requests for passwords, OTPs, bank details, or personal information.
8.	Fake Login Pages	Check whether the email asks you to log in through a suspicious website.
9.	Shortened URLs	Treat shortened links as suspicious because the actual destination is hidden.
10.	Unexpected Emails	Be cautious about unexpected emails claiming to be from banks, companies, or known contacts.

Quick Phishing Check

- ☐ **Sender address verified**
- ☐ **Links checked**
- ☐ **Urgency checked**
- ☐ **Attachments verified**
- ☐ **Spelling and grammar checked**
- ☐ **Personal information request checked**
- ☐ **Website/domain verified**
- ☐ **Email marked suspicious if multiple indicators are present**

Conclusion

A phishing email can often be identified by checking the sender address, links, urgency, attachments, spelling, and requests for sensitive information. Always verify suspicious emails through an official source before taking any action.

Interview Questions

1. How do you identify a phishing email?

I check the sender's email address, suspicious links, urgent language, unexpected attachments, spelling mistakes, and requests for sensitive information.

2. What is spear phishing?

Spear phishing is a targeted phishing attack aimed at a specific person or organization using personalized information.

3. Why are shortened links risky?

Shortened links can hide the actual website address, making it difficult to know whether the destination is safe or malicious.